

FAITHFUL SOFTWARE SOLUTIONS

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PRACTICAL GUIDE

The Manual Process Audit

Find what is costing you time before it costs you growth.

01 Why this matters

The thing that got you here is usually the thing holding you back.

Most growing organisations don't have a process problem. They have a spreadsheet problem. Or a WhatsApp thread problem. Or a 'let me just do it manually this time' problem. Those things work fine when you're small. They stop working the moment your team grows, your volume increases, or someone goes on leave.

The issue isn't that manual processes exist. Every organisation has them. The issue is that most organisations don't know which ones are quietly eating their team's time every single week. They just feel busy. And feeling busy is not the same as being productive.

This guide gives you a structured way to find those processes and decide what to do about them. It won't tell you to automate everything. Some things shouldn't be automated. But the ones that should be, usually have been doing damage for longer than you realise.

Who this guide is for

Operations leads, founders, and admin teams in growing SMEs, schools, churches, and charities.

02 The audit framework

Fill this in for every repeated task your team does weekly. Aim for ten to fifteen entries. Be specific with task names. Vague entries produce vague results.

Task / process name	How often	Who touches it
01 _____	☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly	_____
02 _____	☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly	_____
03 _____	☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly	_____
04 _____	☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly	_____
05 _____	☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly	_____
06 _____	☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly	_____
07 _____	☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly	_____
08 _____	☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly	_____
09 _____	☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly	_____
10 _____	☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly	_____
11 _____	☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly	_____
12 _____	☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly	_____
13 _____	☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly	_____

Tip: include every repeated task, even ones that take under five minutes. Volume adds up.

03 The scoring guide

Once you have your list, score each task on two axes. This tells you what to do first.

Axis 1: Frequency

How often does this task happen?

- 1 Monthly or less
- 2 Weekly
- 3 Multiple times/week
- 4 Daily or more

Axis 2: Judgement

How much human thinking does it need?

- 1 Almost none — rule-based
- 2 Light review or decision
- 3 Moderate judgement
- 4 Complex, context-heavy

Priority matrix

High frequency + Low judgement	Automate first. These are your biggest wins. You are spending real hours on work that a system can do.
High frequency + High judgement	Look at these next. Some can be partially automated. Others need a smarter process, not software.
Low frequency + Any judgement	Leave these for later. Optimise the high-frequency work first.

The three tiers of action

Not everything needs a custom build. Once you have scored your audit, use these tiers to decide what kind of action to take.

Tier 01

Days to implement

Quick wins

Tasks in this tier can be automated or systemised with tools you probably already have. Think Zapier, Airtable, Google Forms, Make, or a simple rule-based workflow in your CRM. The question is not whether to do it. It's why it hasn't been done yet.

Examples:

- Automated email confirmations
- Form-to-spreadsheet data capture
- Recurring calendar invitations
- Simple approval notifications

Tier 02

Weeks to implement

Medium lift

These tasks need a light custom build or a simple integration between two tools that don't naturally talk to each other. A small piece of bespoke software, or a tailored integration, can remove this entirely. The investment is modest; the return is ongoing.

Examples:

- Custom intake forms connected to your database
- Automated reporting from multiple data sources
- Internal tools to replace manual spreadsheet management

Tier 03

Months to implement

Bigger investment

These are the tasks where off-the-shelf software isn't solving your actual problem, and a properly scoped custom solution is the right answer. This takes longer and costs more. But it's also the kind of build that compounds. You stop maintaining workarounds and start operating with a system that fits your organisation.

Examples:

- Custom management platforms replacing spreadsheet-based operations
- Integrated systems connecting multiple data streams
- Client or member portals with role-based access

05 What to do next

If your audit has surfaced a Tier 2 or Tier 3 problem, this is what working with Faithful Software Solutions looks like.

1

Discovery call

We spend 45 minutes on the phone. You walk me through the problem. I ask questions. We figure out whether the problem is real and whether software is the right solution. If it isn't, I'll tell you.

2

Scoping

If there's a fit, I put together a clear scope of work. What gets built, what it connects to, what it doesn't, what it will cost, and what the timeline looks like. No surprises later.

3

Build

We build incrementally. You see working software early, not just at the end. Feedback happens throughout. You're not waiting six months to find out we built the wrong thing.

4

Handover

You get a system your team can use and understand. Documentation, onboarding, and training if needed. Post-launch support included. You're not left guessing.

Every engagement starts with a free discovery call.

No obligation. No pitch deck. Just a conversation about whether we can help.

A closing thought

I started building software for mission-led organisations because I'd seen what happens when the tools don't fit the work. Good people, doing important work, spending half their week managing information instead of doing the thing they actually showed up to do.

That bothered me. It still does.

The organisations I work with are not short on effort or care. They're short on systems that match the way they actually operate. That's a solvable problem. Not always cheaply, not always quickly, but solvable.

This guide is a starting point. If it helps you see your own operation more clearly, it's done its job. If you find something worth fixing, I'd be glad to hear about it.

Jean-Fidele Ntagengwa

Founder, Faithful Software Solutions

Built with purpose. Maintained with care.

That's the only way I know how to build.

GET IN TOUCH

Ready to find out what's costing you?

Book a free 45-minute discovery call. We'll look at what your audit surfaced and talk through whether we can help.

Book a discovery call

WEBSITE	faithfulsoftware.dev
EMAIL	hello@faithfulsoftware.dev
LINKEDIN	linkedin.com/in/jean-fidele-ntagengwa

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